University of St.Gallen

Course and Examination Fact Sheet: Autumn Semester 2025

7,015: Introduction to Business Process Management

ECTS credits: 3

Overview examination/s

(binding regulations see below)
central - Written examination, Digital, Individual work individual grade (100%, 90 mins.)
Examination time: Lecture-free period

Attached courses

Timetable -- Language -- Lecturer
7,015,1.00 Introduction to Business Process Management -- English -- Grisold Thomas

Course information

Prerequisites

This course is assigned to the profile "Transforming and Managing Digital Business", but can also be taken without selecting a specialisation.

Learning objectives

- Holistic understanding about the organizational and managerial implications of Business Process Management (BPM)
- Knowledge about the key assumptions of BPM
- Knowledge about the respective steps of the BPM Lifecycle
- Understanding of the opportunities and threats of a BPM-oriented organization
- Practical knowledge of tasks related to a business process analyst, including the design, analysis and implementation of business processes
- Connection between BPM and other contemporary management topics, including digital innovation and transformation

Content

Business Process Management (BPM) has advanced as a key management approach. At its core, BPM aims at providing organizations with effective and efficient workflows that transform a given input into a desired output. At its heart, BPM combines managerial and organizational practices with a strong focus on various information technologies. As a core technology of BPM, for example, process mining has recently been associated with tremendous economic benefits for companies operating in all kinds of industries.

This course approaches the basics of BPM from two angles.

First, it introduces the basic assumptions of BPM. To this end, it explains why, how and when BPM is useful for organizations. It emphasizes strengths and opportunities of a BPM-driven organization, but it also sheds light on potential downsides and weaknesses.

Second, the course conveys "how-to knowledge", enabling students to understand and apply basic practices of BPM. These include process analysis, process design and process implementation. Various in-class exercises will help students to gain practical knowledge about BPM-related activities.

Structure and indications of the learning and teaching design

- This course counts 3 credits. Accordingly, the total workload for students is 90 hours. This includes self-study, campus time and all examinations.

- The structure of the contact study is planned as follows: 19 hours of lectures during break
- The structure of the self-study is intended as follows: 20 hours of preparation time for the lectures and 51 hours for the examination.
- The course is conducted in presence in St. Gallen.

Additional information regarding course structure and teaching:

- There will be content-related lectures, interactive discussions and hands-on exercises.
- The overall goal is to approach the basis of BPM from two angles:
  On the one hand, it will convey factual knowledge, that is, knowledge related to "what" BPM is and what it assumes about organizations and their environments.
  On the other hand, it will convey hands-on knowledge, that is, knowledge related to "how" BPM can be used and applied within organizational contexts.
- The overall structure of the course will be based on the BPM lifecycle (Dumas et al. 2018).

Literature

- Benner, M. J., & Tushman, M. L. (2003). Exploitation, exploration, and process management: The productivity dilemma revisited. *Academy of management review*, *28*(2), 238-256.
- Berente, N., & Lee, J. (2014). How process improvement efforts can drive organisational innovativeness. *Technology Analysis & Strategic Management*, *26*(4), 417-433.
- Dumas, M., La Rosa, M., Mendling, J., & Reijers, H. A. (2018). *Fundamentals of business process management* (Vol. 2). Heidelberg: Springer.
- Gross, S., Stelzl, K., Grisold, T., Mendling, J., Röglinger, M., & vom Brocke, J. (2021). The Business Process Design Space for exploring process redesign alternatives. *Business Process Management Journal*, *27*(8), 25-56.
- Kettinger, W. J., Teng, J. T., & Guha, S. (1997). Business process change: a study of methodologies, techniques, and tools. *MIS quarterly*, 55-80.
- Malinova, M., & Mendling, J. (2018). Identifying do's and don'ts using the integrated business process management framework. *Business Process Management Journal*, *24*(4), 882-899.
- Recker, J., & Mendling, J. (2016). The state of the art of business process management research as published in the BPM conference: Recommendations for progressing the field. *Business & Information Systems Engineering*, *58*, 55-72.
- Rosemann, M., & vom Brocke, J. (2014). The six core elements of business process management. In *Handbook on business process management 1: introduction, methods, and information systems* (pp. 105-122). Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg.

Additional information

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Examination information

Examination sub part/s

1. Examination sub part (1/1)

Examination modalities

Examination type	Written examination
Responsible for organisation	central
Examination form	Written exam
Examination mode	Digital
Time of examination	Lecture-free period
Examination execution	Synchronous
Examination location	On Campus

Grading type	Individual work individual grade
Weighting	100%
Duration	90 mins.

Languages
Question language: English
Answer language: English

Remark
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Examination-aid rule
Closed Book

The use of aids is prohibited as a matter of principle, with the exception of pocket calculator models of the Texas Instruments TI-30 series and, in case of non-language exams, bilingual dictionaries without any handwritten notes. Any other aids that are admissible must be explicitly listed by faculty members in the paragraph entitled "Supplementary aids" of the course and examination fact sheet; this list is exhaustive.

Procuring any aids, as well as ensuring their working order, is the exclusive responsibility of students.

Supplementary aids

The examination will be conducted as a digital examination with the following admissible devices:

- **Private notebook** (compulsory) – no tablets!
- **Mains adapter** (compulsory)
- External computer mouse (optional)
- External computer keyboard (optional)

We expressly point out that the examination cannot be taken with tablets/iPads

Technical requirements:

- Appliance and system requirements: cf. StudentWeb
- Special software: LockDown Browser
- HSG log-in including access modalities
- WLAN – operational access to Eduroam

Please make sure that

- all the updates have been carried out before the examination.
- in the run-up to digitally conducted examinations, technical tests (mock examinations without grades) are carried out. Participation is urgently required!
- you yourself are responsible for the perfect working order of your appliance, cf. also StudentWeb.
- keyboard stickers in the language in which the examination is conducted (such as English, German, as well as Arabic, Chinese, Russian, Japanese, etc. in language examinations) are permitted. The stickers must be identical with the original characters of the language concerned.

Any use of additional appliances that are not listed above will be strictly prohibited throughout the examination.

Any necessary actions with another software or additional appliances require the express prior approval of the persons in charge of the examination and are only permitted under supervision.

Any infringement of these rules of conduct may be sanctioned as an infringement of the rules of the University.

Content

The design of the exam will be based on all contents that have been covered in the lecture. This pertains to slides, readings and hands-on exercises. Please note that discussions and reflections during the lectures will also be relevant for the exam.

Literature

The relevant literature will be based on the literature recommendations and can be further specified over the progression of the course.

Please note

Please note that only this fact sheet and the examination schedule published at the time of bidding are binding and takes precedence over other information, such as information on StudyNet (Canvas), on lecturers' websites and information in lectures etc.
Any references and links to third-party content within the fact sheet are only of a supplementary, informative nature and lie outside the area of responsibility of the University of St.Gallen.

Documents and materials are only relevant for central examinations if they are available by the end of the lecture period (CW51) at the latest. In the case of centrally organised mid-term examinations, the documents and materials up to CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025) are relevant for testing.

Binding nature of the fact sheets:

- Course information as well as examination date (organised centrally/decentrally) and form of examination: from bidding start in CW 34 (Thursday, 21 August 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for decentralised examinations: in CW 42 (Monday, 13. October 2025);
- Examination information (supplementary aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised mid-term examinations: in CW 43 (Freitag, 24. October 2025);
- Examination information (regulations on aids, examination contents, examination literature) for centrally organised examinations: two weeks before ending with de-registration period in CW 45 (Monday, 03. November 2025).